# Early Childhood Licensing
# Serious Injuries, Deaths, and Instances of Substantiated Child Abuse in Child Care

NORTH Dakota | Human Services
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**Our goal is to keep children safe. We have rules in place for child care settings, regularly inspect them, and provide training and support to help programs and providers understand and meet these rules. However, children are naturally curious explorers and sometimes get hurt, even under ideal conditions. Also, child care providers sometimes make mistakes and unknowingly or knowingly violate the rules, which may result in child injury.**

### Where does this information come from?

Child care providers are required to report to their Early Childhood Licensing Specialist when a child is seriously injured or dies in care, even if it wasn't the result of a rule violation. They are also required to report when a child is abused or neglected. Parents or other individuals can report concerns by contacting their local Early Childhood Licensing Specialist.

### What is this data used for?

Families need information in order to make informed choices about who will care for their children while parents and guardians are working or in education or training. This information helps parents choose a child care provider that best meets their family's needs.

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### Total Number of Children in Care, Serious Injuries, and Deaths, by License Type, for Providers Eligible to Serve CCDF Children

This table displays the annual number of serious injuries and deaths that occurred in licensed and licensed-exempt programs over a 3-year period. It also includes the estimated total number of children in each type of care.

A **serious injury** is defined as any accident or injury which occurs in the early childhood setting or as a result of care provided in the early childhood setting and results in medical treatment. Medical treatment is considered any treatment beyond basic First Aid.

| All Licensed and Licensed-Exempt Providers | 2019 | | | 2020 | | | 2021 | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Estimated # of Children in Care | # of Serious Injuries | # of Deaths | Estimated # of Children in Care | # of Serious Injuries | # of Deaths | Estimated # of Children in Care | # of Serious Injuries | # of Deaths |
| **Family Child Care** | 37,682 | 114 | 0 | 37,530 | 3 | 0 | 1,791 | 1 | 0 |
| **Group Child Care** | | | | | 25 | 0 | 12,061 | 18 | 0 |
| **Child Care Center** | | | | | 55 | 0 | 12,862 | 33 | 0 |
| **Preschool Programs** | | | | | 1 | 0 | 1,165 | 1 | 0 |
| **School Age Programs** | | | | | 7 | 0 | 3,782 | 6 | 0 |
| **Multi-Licensed Facility** | | | | | 34 | 0 | 7,088 | 24 | 0 |
| **Self-Declared Providers** | N/A | | | N/A | 0 | 0 | 210 | 0 | 0 |

### Total Instances of Substantiated Child Abuse and Neglect, for Providers Eligible to Serve CCDF Children

This table includes the annual total instances of substantiated child abuse and neglect that occurred in licensed and license-exempt programs over a 3-year period.

| All Licensed and License-Exempt Providers | 2019 | 2020 | 2021 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Total** | 11 | 3 | 4 |

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### What types of child care does this information apply to?

**Licensed Child Care Providers**

- **Licensed Family Child Care:** Family providers may care for up to 7 children of which no more than 3 children are under the age of 24 months, plus two additional school-age children.
- **Licensed Group Child Care:** Group child care programs may be licensed in a home or a facility. Groups may be licensed for up to 30 children, with the actual license capacity determined by available space, staff to child ratios, and sometimes local ordinances.
- **Licensed Child Care Center:** Child care centers are licensed for at least 19 children in a facility, with the actual license capacity determined by available space, staff to child ratios, and sometimes local ordinances.
- **Licensed Preschool Programs:** Preschools provide educational and socialization experiences for children age 2 years to kindergarten and may operate sessions for no more than 3 hours per day.
- **Licensed School-Age Programs:** School-age programs are licensed for at least 19 children in a facility, with the actual license capacity determined by available space, staff to child ratios, and sometimes local ordinances. School-age programs offer services before and after school, and sometimes on school holidays and through the summer months.
- **Multiple License Facility:** This type of program has more than one type of license, such as a center and preschool.

**License-Exempt Child Care Providers**

- **Self-Declared Providers:** Care for 5 or fewer children or 3 children under 24 months in a home. These providers must meet some minimal standards, including a background check and basic health and safety training, are inspected prior to annual approval, and receive one additional monitoring visit per year. Self-declared providers are eligible to participate in the Child Care Assistance Program and the USDA Food program.

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